

# Little Commanders

2–6 players · 30–45 minutes · ages 8+

Rulebook draft v0.3. Working title, art and numbers will change.

## 1 The Game in One Minute

You are a kid commander with cute little  **Bots** and a few big  **Mechs**. Spread across the hex floor, hold tiles, and complete  **Missions** to earn  **Victory Points**. The first commander to reach the target wins.

**Two rules to remember.** (1) You spend  Credits to recruit, move and buy Missions. (2) Move onto an enemy tile with more strength than the defenders and they must go. Start with the Basic game and add layers. Everything else is printed on your board, the tiles and the cards.

## 2 Icons

The same pictures are used on tiles, cards, boards and in this book.

|                                                                                     |                   |                                                                                     |                 |                                                                                       |                |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
|   | Credit            |   | Iron            |   | Crystal        |
|  | Bot (power 1)     |  | Mech (power 5)  |  | Victory Point  |
|  | Extractor         |  | Factory         |  | Guard Tower    |
|  | Dock              |  | Port            |  | Mission card   |
|  | Move (1 per step) |  | Push            |  | Kill           |
|  | Income            |  | Trade           |  | Used this turn |
|  | Tile              |  | Centre tile     |  | Control a tile |
|  | Price goes up     |  | Price goes down |  | Road           |

## 3 Components

- **Tiles:** 37 land tiles, 6 Home tiles, 12 Port tiles (Ports only in the Full game).
- **Boards:** 6 Commander boards (Basic side and Advanced side), 1 Market board (Full game).
- **Per commander:** 20 Bots, 6 Mechs, 5 Extractors, 5 Factories, 5 Guard Towers, 1 Dock.
- **Tokens:** Iron, Crystal, Credit coins (1, 5, 10), price markers, VP markers.
- **Cards:** 40 Missions (20 of Level 1, 20 of Level 2).

## 4 Choose Your Level

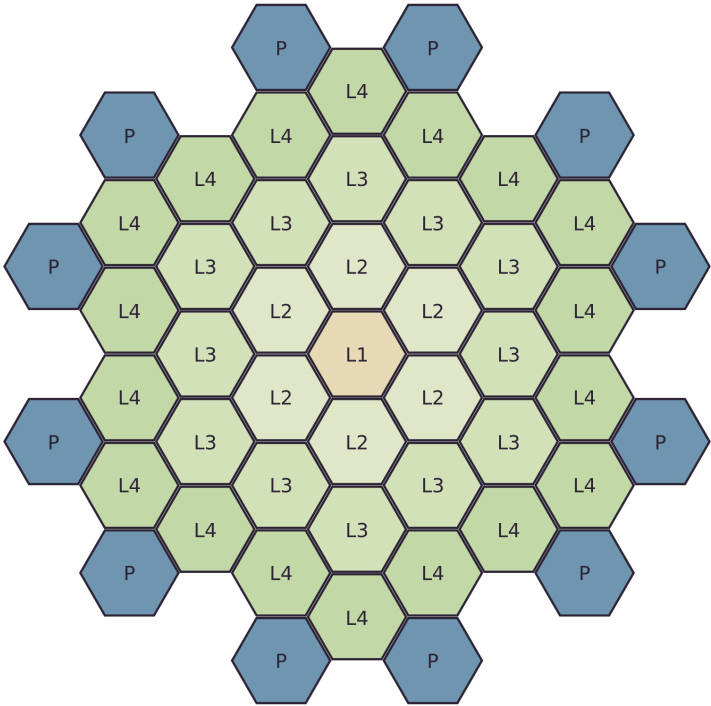
Every level adds one layer to the one before. Start with Basic; add a layer when everyone is ready.

| Level        | What it adds                                         | Win at |
|--------------|------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| 1 Basic      | Bots,  Credits,  Missions                            | 3      |
| 2 Production | Iron,  Crystal,  Extractor,  Factory,  Guard Tower   | 5      |
| 3 Mechs      | Mechs (power 5) and strong combat (push 2×, kill 3×) | 5      |
| 4 Full game  | Market:  Docks,  Ports, moving prices                | 5      |

On BGA this is the *Rules* game option.

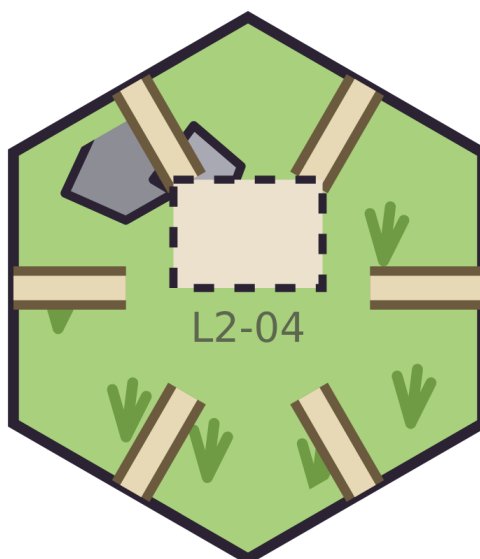
## 5 Setup

1. **Build the floor.** 2–3 players: 19 land tiles (centre and 2 rings). 4–6 players: 37 land tiles (centre and 3 rings). Shuffle the tiles of each ring and place them at random, then check that you can walk from the centre to every tile over roads that *both* touching tiles show (re-deal if not).
2. **Homes.** Space the Home tiles evenly on the outer ring. Each player takes the one in their colour with **3 Bots** and **2 Credits**. From Level 2 also a Guard Tower and **2 Iron**.
3. **Ports** (Full game). Place 2 Port tiles per player around the outside, each beside 2 land tiles, and give every player a Dock on their home tile.
4. **Missions.** Reveal 5 Missions from a deck of Level 1 cards with Level 2 cards below. Only cards that can be done at your level are used.
5. **Market** (Full game). Put each price marker at random in its starting band: Iron 4–7, Bots 4–7, Crystal 8–14, Mechs 8–14.



Four to six players: 37 land tiles and 12 Ports (shown schematically; L = land level, P = port).

## 6 Reading a Tile



Everything you need is printed on the tile itself.

- **Ground:** green  Iron mine, blue  Crystal deposit, grey empty tile, or a green tile with both resources.
- **Sockets:** 0, 1 or 2 square building areas where you may build.
- **Roads:** a road on an edge means this tile connects there. A tiny broken stump means no road. Pieces only travel where *both* tiles show a road.
- **Code:** the small label (e.g. L2-04) is only for talking about tiles. On BGA, letters and numbers around the board name every tile (the same names appear in the log).
- **Ports:** show the good and a  (2 cheaper to buy) or  (3 more when you sell).

Tiles nearer the centre have more roads. The  centre has all six.

## 7 Level 1: Basic Game

Use the Basic side of your board.

### Your turn

1.  **Income:** gain 1 Credit for every tile you hold. You  hold a tile while one of your pieces stands on it.
2. **Spend Credits** in any order:  recruit a Bot on your home tile (2; your home must not be held by an enemy);  move a piece one step along a road (1 per step, each piece);  buy a Mission (5, plus 1 for every Mission you have bought; one per turn).
3.  **Fight:** move onto an enemy tile. Your attack is decided when you end your turn. With more Bots than the defenders, they retreat (their owner chooses where). Otherwise yours go back.

**Win** by being first to 3  Victory Points. A Mission scores only if you meet its condition at the moment you buy it.

## 8 Levels 2–4: More Rules

Turn your board to the Advanced side. Income stays the same: 1 Credit for every tile you hold. You win at 5 .

### Level 2: Production

Spend  Iron that is standing on the tile on a free socket there. Build your first Extractor with your starting Iron.

|                                                                                   |             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                       |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  | Extractor   | Once per turn, pay 1 Credit: take 1 token of the tile's resource.                                                                                                                                                | 1  |
|  | Factory     | Once per turn, pay 1 Credit: 1  becomes 2  . | 2  |
|  | Guard Tower | Counts as 1 more defender on its tile.                                                                                                                                                                           | 2  |

When a building works, put a  coin on it. Take the coins back at the start of your turn. You may sell a building: it returns to your board and you get its cost minus 1 Iron on the tile. Resource tokens belong to whoever holds the tile; carry them with your pieces (1 Credit per step each). You can still recruit Bots at home for 2 Credits.

### Level 3: Mechs

A Factory can also turn 1  + 1  into 1  Mech. Combat gets stronger:

-  Bot power 1.  Mech power 5. Add up each side's power.
-  **Push:** attackers have at least  $2\times$  the defenders' power. The defenders retreat; the defending player chooses where each piece goes.
-  **Kill:** at least  $3\times$ . The defenders are removed.
-  Each Guard Tower on the tile adds 1 to both multipliers ( $2 \rightarrow 3$ ,  $3 \rightarrow 4$ , ...).
- Not enough? The attack **fails** and the attackers return to where they came from.

### Level 4: Market

 Stand on a tile with your  Dock or on a  Port. Each post trades once per turn: pay 1 Credit, then choose one good and buy or sell any number of it at the current price.

- **Home Dock:** Iron and Bots, at the normal price.
- **Port:** one good is 2 cheaper to buy, or pays 3 more when sold.
- Afterwards the price moves one step for every item traded:  when you buy,  when you sell. A step is 1 Credit for Iron and Bots and 2 for Crystal and Mechs.
- Ranges: Iron 1–10, Bots 1–10, Crystal 2–20, Mechs 2–20.
- You can no longer recruit Bots at home: buy them here or make them in a Factory.

## Missions

Pay  **5 Credits** to buy a face-up Mission, plus 1 for every Mission you have bought. You may buy one per turn. If you meet it *at that moment*, you score its  (1 for Level 1 cards, 2 for Level 2 cards). If not, the Credits are lost. A completed card is replaced from the deck. Higher levels add cards about buildings, resources, Mechs and Ports.



## Winning

Be first to reach the target: 3  at Level 1, 5  at Levels 2–4. Points come only from Missions.

## 9 Factions

Each commander has a colour and a different silhouette, so the game also works without colour vision. Faction powers are an optional extra still being designed.

# 10 Your Board

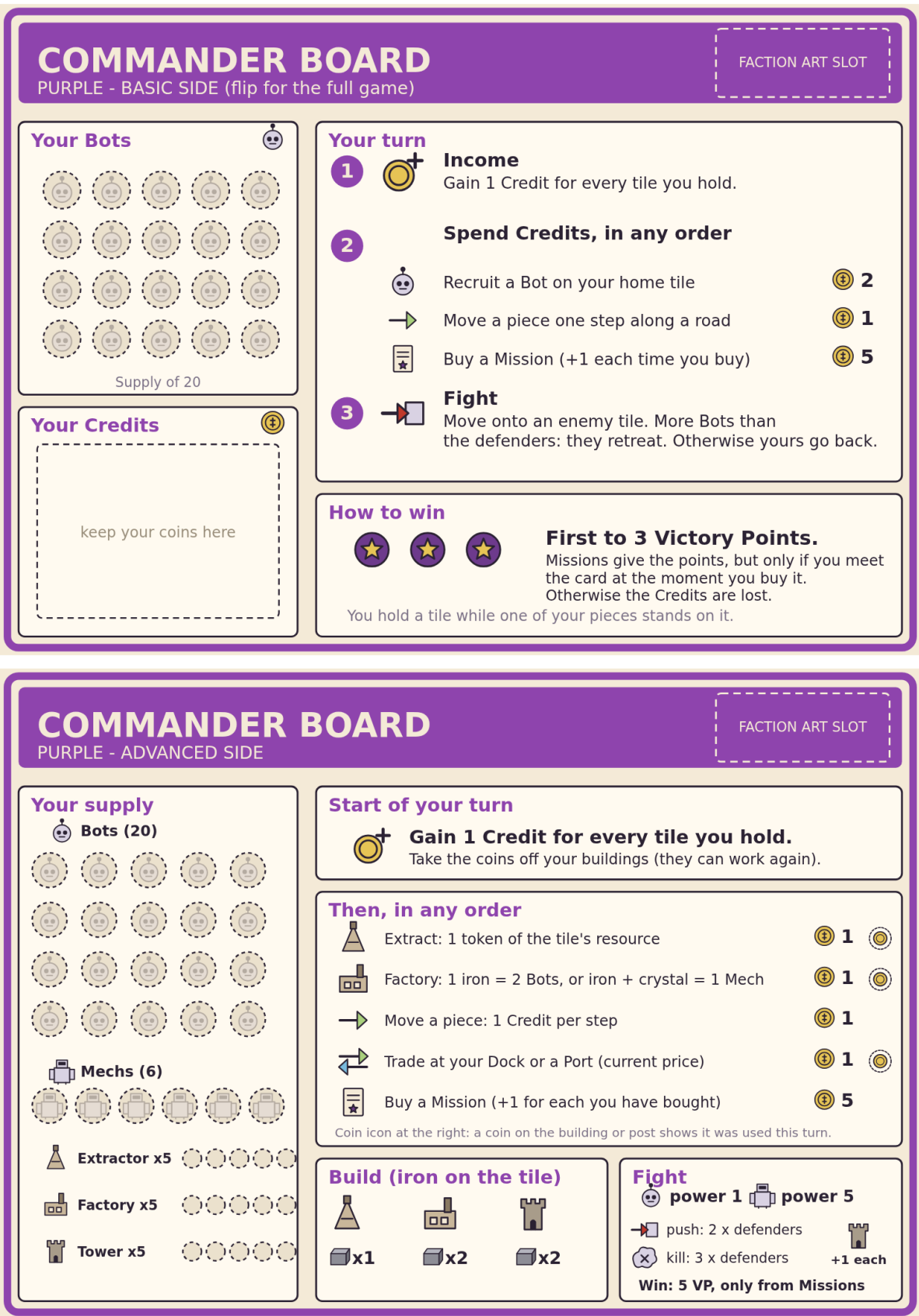


Figure 1: Basic side (front) and Advanced side (back).

## 11 Draft Notes

- Basic numbers (2 Credits per Bot, 3 VP, 2 starting Credits) are untested.
- Income changed from a flat 10 Credits to 1 per tile held. Movement was triangular (1, 3, 6, 10 per piece) and is now linear; see `DESIGN_NOTES.md`.
- The market still prices a whole trade at today's price before moving, so big buy-and-sell loops between a Dock and a Port can print Credits. Needs per-item price steps or fixed port prices.